

**NOTES**  
**Medford School Committee**

**Monday, January 10, 2022**

***Regular Meeting: 6:30 PM***

**Meeting on zoom only due to COVID exposures of members/staff**

**Roll Call for Attendance of Members and the Student Representatives: 7 present/0 absent**

**Salute the Flag**

**Organization of the School Committee: Election of School Committee Officers**

Paul Ruseau: Nominated Jenny Graham for Vice Chair

Melanie McLaughlin: Seconded it

Roll Call:

Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Paul Ruseau, Melanie McLaughlin, Jenny Graham, Mea Mustone,  
Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7 in the affirmative electing Jenny Graham as Vice Chair

Jenny Graham: Nominating Paul Ruseau for Secretary

Kathy Kreatz: Second

Roll Call:

Sharon Hays, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Jenny Graham, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau,  
Breanna Lungo-Koehn  
7 in the affirmative electing Paul Ruseau as Secretary

**Good of the Order**

Melanie McLaughlin: Review of School Committee best practices and moving things forward.  
There is not much in the way of SC orientation practices. I would like to open that up to  
colleagues on this issue (Parliamentary procedure, policies, who to go to when?)

Breanna Lungo-Koehn: I feel like what we did a couple of years ago was a good start. Supt.  
Edouard-Vincent wants to get us together after the surge.

Paul Ruseau: On the next agenda, I am sending a set of goals to the Rules Committee and hope  
we can build out a whole section on orientation. I asked Sharon Hays to write as much as  
possible when she reads the rules. Her perspective will be valuable when it comes to orientation.

Melanie McLaughlin: I also appreciate the event Supt. Edouard-Vincent hosted with MASC a  
couple of years ago. I want the committee to think about doing this earlier than was done back  
then.

Kathy Kreatz: The orientation that Supt. Edouard-Vincent did with Dorothy from MASC was very helpful. It would be great to have a refresher. I look forward to doing that.

Jenny Graham: Welcome to new School Committee member Sharon Hays. Thank you for joining us. You should not hesitate to reach out to any of us if you have any questions.

Supt. Marice Edouard-Vincent: I look forward to having the retreat in February.

### **Consent Agenda**

- Approval of Bills/Payrolls
- Regular School Committee Meeting Minutes, 12.20.2021

Motion to approve: Melanie McLaughlin/Jenny Graham

Roll Call: Hays/Graham/Kreatz/McLaughlin/Mustone/Ruseau/Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 consent agenda approved.

### **Report of the Superintendent**

1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Happy New Year: This is our first meeting of 2022. The weather forecast for tomorrow calls for extremely cold temperatures. We have taken steps to prepare for these near zero temperatures. We ask that students arrive wearing adequate clothing. We are working to make sure all is operational despite temps. There is a risk of bus driver absences tomorrow. I am asking families to minimize the amount of time your child is waiting at the bus stop tomorrow. Students at the elementary schools will be allowed to enter their schools by 8:15am, at middle schools by 7:30am, and at Medford High School by 7:20am. We want to make sure each of our students are kept safe and ready to learn throughout our school district.

**Unfortunately, again due to Covid concerns, the original Inaugural plans had to change, but I did watch the ceremony.** As the Mayor said in her Inaugural Address, we are proud that the Medford Public Schools, due to our collaboration with Tufts University, was able to bring our students back into school sooner than most surrounding districts. The teamwork of the City, Tufts and the schools, worked hand in hand to make in-person school a reality. I want to congratulate all of you and officially welcome Sharon Hays aboard as the newest member of the Medford School Committee.

**Today the Medford Public Schools opened registration for our incoming Kindergarten students.** Anyone with questions should contact the Parent Information Center.

### **UPCOMING EVENTS:**

**The next vaccine clinic will be held at Medford High School, this Wednesday, January 12th from 3-6 PM.** Vaccines are available for students aged 5-11 years old as well as students and staff aged 12 and up. We strongly urge anyone who has not yet completed their series of shots to do so as early as possible.

**The first SEPAC meeting of the new year will also be held, Wednesday, January 12th from 6-8 PM,** via Zoom featuring Disability Awareness Curriculum.

**Thursday, January 13th, the first of three Building Bridges to Kindergarten presentations** will be held via Zoom from 6:30-7:30 PM

**There is No School, next Monday, January 17th in honor of Martin Luther King, Jr.** On that day, the West Medford Community Center along with many of our students from CCSR, will present Medford Celebrates Martin Luther King, Jr, at 11 AM The event will be available via Zoom. We hope you will join us.

**Speaking of the West Medford Community Center, I would like to take this opportunity to welcome their new Executive Director Lisa Crossman.** Lisa comes to Medford with over twenty years of youth based programming and community organizing experience. We welcome her to our community.

The Equity Process will be starting their work in Medford. They will assist with the RETF, will work with the School Committee to foster positive relationships and create learning environments where all people feel welcomed. They will come to the School Committee to introduce themselves to you and share more of the work they will do with us including their equity audit.

**As we begin 2022, I would like share a few lines from poet Amanda Gorman's New Day's Lyric, that she wrote to celebrate the new year and honor the hurt and humanity of last year:**

"This hope is our door, our portal. Even if we never get back to normal, Someday we can venture beyond it, To leave the known and take the first steps. So let us not return to what was normal, But reach toward what is next."

Melanie McLaughlin: question regarding the equity work: Is the name of the company Equity Process?

Marice Edouard-Vincent: Yes

Melanie McLaughlin: How many phases will there be to this work?

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: There is a portion when they will go into schools and gather information but I asked that they wait on that until Sept. 2022 because of the pandemic. They will start with a document and policy review and work with central administration, hr, policies. It potentially could be a three year process due to the pandemic. They just finished their work in Lynnfield.

Melanie McLaughlin: I am sure all abilities are part of this work?

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: Yes it is.

**COVID Update** -Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations David Murphy and Avery Hines  
Director of Health Services

**Dave Murphy:**

Vaccines: Next clinic is Wednesday, January 12th from 3 to 6 PM at MHS for students and staff. Offering 1st, 2nd and boosters. Our nurses are phone banking those who are unvaccinated and encouraging them to participate in the clinics. We have vaccinated 100s already. We did have some who could not get vaccinated because they were temporarily postponed due to COVID exposure.

Testing: Robust surveillance testing programs in partnership with Tufts University. It has been successful but it is not designed for the current surge environment. It was not designed for post vaccination phase of the pandemic. We will continue PCR testing this and next week but we need to get back to Pooled testing by the end of the month. We hope that we see the number of cases will drop by then. It is not sustainable to continue individual testing for much longer. We will need to institute some changes in the process when we switch back to pooled testing. We will look at the data as we make the decision to move from surveillance to diagnostic testing (test and stay). The level of positivity has an impact on the sustainability of surveillance testing.

Protocols: Lots of questions regarding CDC endorsed 5 day isolation period. We will make this change next week. In addition to following the science, it is difficult for families to hear from dr. that period is 5 days and then schools tell them to isolate for 10 days. The DESE mandate with face masks is set until end of February. Our distancing guidelines remain the same and contact tracing efforts will transition as well when we switch to diagnostic testing.

The last week was very difficult and we are doing as best to respond. I know there are concerns with staff and student absenteeism. We have a 90% vaccination with staff but staff absences have not been debilitating. We will provide specific numbers later in the week in regards to student absenteeism and will make sure they are coded correctly in the platform. It is higher than normal but not debilitating.

**Avery Hines:**

Data is what we collected last week coming back from great.

3271 individual PCR. tests - 233 positives. 126 positive from self reported at home testing. Shocking to see the numbers. We did 153 vaccinations last Wednesday. We have 218 appointments scheduled for this Wednesday. I hope that we stay as close as we can to 218. In terms of visits to the nurses office, we had 111 students coming to school seeking a test with symptoms. We recognize there are limited testing options, we can't have individuals coming in and exposing others. This is unsustainable. The number of phone calls is overwhelming. The numbers speak volumes for the work that our nursing staff is doing.

David Murphy: We want to communicate to the community that some improvements will out live the pandemic but others will not. We need to be nimble to be able to keep up with changes that need to happen with our testing program.

Melanie McLaughlin: Thank you Ms. Hines and to all the nurses. Data tells the story. I am wondering about the at home testing. I have spoken to community members needing to quarantine back to back, sometimes for students with learning disabilities. Is it accurate that a negative home test doesn't qualify for return to school?

Avery Hines: Previous guidance has suggested that we don't accept home tests but we are going to transition next week.

David Murphy: CDC guidance came out in a clunky fashion. We wanted to see how the CDC roll out proceeded and also look at the data to decide to make the transition. Working with the BOH, we can accept that beginning next week.

Melanie McLaughlin: For students being exposed multiple times and missing weeks of school, is there oppty.for remediation?

Dave Murphy: Type of individualized support needs to be tailored to the situation. 3 prongs: what is the grade level, content area and particular lesson? We ask administrators to look at these situations on a case by case basis. We will use ESSER funding to roll out remediation opportunities in the Spring. This is a huge disruption to education. It is incumbent on us to make sure we support our students and help them recover. We cannot underestimate the scale of the disruption. A way to avoid this: get all students vaccinated.

Paul Ruseau: Thank you to all the MPS staff. I have questions about test and stay. I have heard from other districts doing test and stay. Due to the inability to have enough tests in stock, nurses have had to ration the tests to who we feel needs the tests the most. Are there hopes that we will have enough tests to do test and stay? I don't want to dangle the test and stay unless we know we have the tests available. Is the isolation time frame the same for vaccinated or unvaccinated students?

Avery Hines: Yes. The difference is symptomology when you test positive. If you continue to have symptoms after 5 days, you need to continue to isolate. The tests provided for Test and Stay are through the state and CIC. With test and stay, students are tested upon arrival to school with a rapid test. Test and stay is only for unvaccinated close contacts.

Sharon Hays: Thank you all for the work you are doing. My question is about communication: at the last meeting there was discussion about written communication going home in backpacks/folders. As much as communication as possible is essential. We really do want to get people vaccinated and know how to register.

Dave Murphy: We are trying to communicate in every way possible. Using the backpack method is a great idea and we should go to that next week. I would like to send out a notice of the changes right before we make the actual shifts.

Melanie McLaughlin: a simple visual will be helpful. A ticker on Medford Community media would be great too. Is it the unvaccinated who gets the test and stay.

Avery Hines: Vaccinated exposures are not required to quarantine. If they have an out of school exposure, they are not able to use test and stay.

David Murphy: Contingent upon the symptoms the person is experiencing.

Jenny Graham: Has been there talk in the CDC about changes for protocols for vaccinated students?

David Murphy: Not yet.

Jenny Graham: We are not seeing a change requiring vaccinated students doing anything different than they are doing today? Is there data at the state level regarding breakthrough infections in the school age population?

Avery Hines: We track all the positives that we know about. It probably could be pulled together. I don't know how accurate it would be due to reliance on people reporting at home tests.

David Murphy: We are seeing a lower rate of positives in those who are vaxxed and boosted. It is anecdotal evidence.

Jenny Graham: Last week leading up to the clinics, people commented that the system was full. Is there an upper limit? I just want to everyone to take advantage of the clinics.

David Murphy: the Board of Health is our supplier. We have 218 people signed up right now and we do have more than 218 to cover it. We are likely to be able to accept walkins but our goal is for people to use the registration form for logistical purposes.

Kathy Kreatz: thanks to all the nurses for what they are doing. Do we have the COVID exposure guidance on the website? Will it be updated for next week?

Dave Murphy: We will do our best to get the information out there to families as to what steps they should take when there is exposure? We have become a very good resource for all things COVID in the community (testing/vaccination). We can't make this take over our responsibility to educate children. As the role of the pandemic changes in our society, and recognize that COVID will be in our lives, we need to communicate as accurately as we can to the community at all times.

Sharon Hays: Can you give an update on the in school/school day vaccination opportunities?

David Murphy: We will be working on that with the Board of Health in the next couple of weeks.

#### **Assessment Update - Assistant Superintendent of Secondary Education Dr. Peter Cushing**

Last week we received notice from the state that ACCESS testing will continue through March 4. We are shifting our NWEA Map growth tests as well. Secondary team will provide an information session so parents can learn about their students scores now that these reports will be part of students' academic portfolios going forward.

This year, we provided free PSATS. 88% of our 10th and 11th grade students took the PSAT. Allows us access to a tool called AP Potential. Identifies students likely to score a 3 or higher on AP exams. It does not eliminate students from potential AP opportunities.

Last week during the commissioners' call, MCAS still slated to take place. DESE is participating in a call with the Federal Dept. of Ed and we will soon get updates from that.

Jenny Graham: Some parents are asking for access to the scores prior to the second set of scores in February. There are no middle school conferences built in.

Peter Cushing: We didn't have the opportunity with conferences. NWEA Map expressed they thought we should wait to show growth. Since it is a new assessment, there may be struggles with actually taking the assessment. The reports will be distributed so they can have that information.

Jenny Graham: On the list of approved reports, we had screener reports on the elementary level. I want to make sure that the School Committee receives aggregated reports from these assessments. I would like to see them presented to us in a more formal manner going forward. We are responsible for academic success and we have no tools for determining that right now.

Peter Cushing: We definitely will make this information available to you. MAP is a great tool to be able to evaluate curriculum enhancements we are implementing.

Jenny Graham: I want to make sure it will not be withheld next year after the first test next year?

Peter Cushing: Yes. Since it was the first time, we wanted to make sure we didn't alarm parents.

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: I am so excited to have this tool but moving forward, we will have this data available. I look forward to digging deeply into this data k-12. Now more than ever since the MCAS cycle has been interrupted.

**English Learners (EL) Updates- Director of English Learners Paul Teixeira will report on 2021 WIDA ACCESS scores and English Learners Department updates.**

Paul Teixeira: Every January, we give out the access test (four different tests). As Dr. C mentioned, they extended the date until March 4. We staggered the tests throughout the district. 100% were done on the chromebooks last year and the tech dept. Works with us to make sure it goes smoothly. With the delay, we probably won't get the results until August 2022. I gave a chart with Medford scores last year. Students can be exit-ed after achieving 4.2. At the end of every school year, we have language acquisition team meetings so make classroom placements and scheduling choices. Medford has a 95% participation rate on the test. We have 44% making improvement on the access test which was high compared to neighboring districts during the pandemic. The School Committee made sure that our EL students were back safely in Sept. 2020 and the data shows that it was a good choice. We can compare ourselves to the state and we compare ourselves to other districts. Looking at the previous years data (2020) and then April 2021, this all accounted for immeasurable loss of instruction for students. It can't

be measured. Students not making progress increased by 9% last year. Grade 6 - 8 students (22%) didn't make progress. Co-teaching makes a big difference. If this data tells us anything, we need to continue with the co-teaching model. Updates on Enrollment: compared to last year, our numbers were down (borders were closed)- 410 students. We now have 511 EL students. Our numbers continue to grow. Registration data: for 2021 data wasn't available. State allowed us to use home language survey and previous school records instead of the entry assessment. As of now we have tested 301 students, 244 have qualified for EL services. We will get another surge of new students at this time of year as many students come from Brazil at this time.

Partnering with *Tech Goes Home*. This organization provides education to caregivers on use of technology. Caregivers will get a chromebook and free year of internet access if they take the 10 hour course. I am using title 3 funds to pay the teachers. We can continue this partnership as long as they want to partner with us.

Family engagement begins when students arrive at the high school for testing. Emily has taken over for Jessie Reinold. She is the first contact and does a great job of making families feel welcome. We are doing our building based family engagement nights in February and March. District EL advisory council meeting is scheduled for March 24th in the Library at Medford High School - self run parent, caregiver organization that will advise the central office on what they would like to see for their students.

Melanie McLaughlin: How much does *Tech Goes Home* costs for the teachers?

Paul Teixeira: the teachers make their own schedules for the ten hours. They get paid \$33/hour.

Melanie McLaughlin: You mentioned a Resiliency hub??

Paul Teixeira: it is part of the Medford City hall website. Lists resources for food and housing. Multilingual resource hub.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Goal is to create a resiliency hub.

Melanie McLaughlin: Opportunity to recruit participants for the Parent Advisory Group.

Paul Teixeira: Yes we have found that parents are more willing to participate at a school level rather than at the district level to start.

## **New Business**

1. Given the substantial limitation of the use of out-of-school suspensions approved unanimously by the Medford School Committee on October 14, 2020; and given this change allowed for nearly a year of planning for implementation by district leadership: the Superintendent will present the plans that were developed in that year prior to this change, including how principals and assistant principals were trained on changes they have implemented at the start of this school year to comply with this change in policy; the

number of detentions, Saturday detentions, in-school suspensions, and any out-of-school suspensions issued from the start of the 2021-2022 school year through October 31 disaggregated by school and grade level; professional development offered to any staff and the percentage of staff by type and school level that participated; challenges that are being worked through; recommendations the School Committee should consider to assist with implementation of the policy; and future plans for continuing this work to ensure all students have access to the education they have a right to under the Massachusetts Constitution.

- *Offered by: Paul Ruseau (Tabled on 12.6.2021 and 12.20.2021)*

*Motion to waive the reading: Paul Ruseau/Jenny Graham: Roll:Jenny Graham/Sharon Hays/Kathy Kreatez/Melanie McLaughlin/Mea Mustone/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Lungo-Koehn 7/0 waived reading the motion.*

*Paul Ruseau:* This is a motion asking the administration to provide us a presentation on the implementation of the out of school suspension policy. Can we change the date to December 31, 2021?

Peter Cushing: yes no problem

Motion to approve: Jenny Graham/Paul Ruseau

Jenny Graham/Sharon Hays/Kathy Kreatez/Melanie McLaughlin/Mea Mustone/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Lungo-Ko: 7/0 motion approved

2. Be it resolved that the administration will present the proposed rate for the Before and After School Program to the Medford School Committee for approval no later than March 1st. Be it further resolved that the rate recommendation will take into account the costs of the current program and the market rates in area programs.

- *Offered by Jenny Graham and Paul Ruseau*

Jenny Graham: We talked in past years that access to the program is difficult. Kindergarten registration just opened and I want to make sure we set the rates so we can start the registration process going.

David Murphy: This is an action we have been anticipating. We have been researching rates in other districts. We anticipate being able to offer this before March 1st. A variable that has changed since last spring is a workforce depletion. That will need to be part of the conversation. No indication there will be a staffing turnaround in the coming months. We are preparing a presentation spelling out the options for

the committee spelling out a fee increase. We had a surplus in that account that allowed us to raise the wages but still anticipate staffing challenges. My guess will be early February.

Motion to approve: Paul Ruseau/Jenny Graham

Roll: Jenny Graham/Sharon Hays/Kathy Kreatz/Melanie McLaughlin/Mea Mustone/Paul Ruseau/Mayor Lungo-Koehn: 7/0 motion approved

3. Be it resolved that the Medford School Committee will amend policy BDE - Subcommittees of the School Committee:

The School Committee maintains a set of standing subcommittees during each term. It may establish special subcommittees for a specific purpose and to make recommendations for Committee action per policy [BDF](#).

1. The Committee chairperson, subject to approval by the Committee, will establish standing committees in the first month of each term. The subcommittee will be established through action of the Committee.
2. The Committee chairperson, subject to approval by the Committee, will appoint the subcommittee chairperson and its members.
3. The subcommittee may only meet to carry out business referred to it by a majority vote of the Committee. Subcommittees will not meet to conduct business brought to the Subcommittee by any other means or process. will be provided with a list of its functions and duties.
4. The subcommittee may make recommendations for Committee action, but it may not act for the School Committee.
5. The Committee chairperson and Superintendent will be ex-officio members of all special subcommittees.
6. A subcommittee will be dissolved by the Committee upon completion of its assignment, or it may be dissolved by a vote of the Committee at any time.

CROSS REF.: [BEC](#), Executive Sessions

- *Offered by Jenny Graham*

*Jenny Graham:* I would like to see the committees have more finite and clear functions. I sent a document with the policy in track mode. Significant change is that subcommittees should only meet if assigned a task at the regular school committee meeting.

Melanie McLaughlin; I would like to look at this in the rules subcommittee. I would like the community members to be able to access us on specific ideas. I make a motion to send it to Rules Subcommittee.

Kathy Kreatz: In reading number 3, I have built the building and grounds agenda based on community input and input from the administration/and John McLaughlin. Would I have to wait for items to get referred to the committee before I put it on the Buildings and Grounds agenda.

Paul Ruseau: Number 3 is how all legislative bodies do their work. I do think that when we spend our money, the whole committee needs to approve it. Without the full committee, I don't think a chair of a subcommittee has the authority to push things forward. We as individual subcommittees don't have the authority to spend money.

Kathy Kreatz: I am not talking about spending money. I am talking about sharing information I gather as chair of the buildings and grounds committee. How would items get referred for example the only way to have something referred is putting a resolution on the agenda?

Jenny Graham: Yes - you would put it on this agenda and then you would go to subcommittee. It is up to whole committee to approve the use of meeting time. These meetings take up administrator time. I think it is a better way to identify the priorities of the committee.

Kathy Kreatz: For example, if I had four or five things, would I do that many resolutions on the agenda? I don't know what my responsibilities would be.

Jenny Graham: yes the resolution would list all the items. The committee could sever something out if they don't agree it requires attention or if it should be addressed at a regular meeting.

Melanie McLaughlin: The subcommittees have been a big part of community engagement so it is concerning for me. First we would have to get approval and then schedule the meeting. A lot of times, the subcommittee are a way of arriving at policy suggestions to get approved by the whole committee. I would amend my motion to move it to a COW so we can collaborate on efficient use of our time.

Mea Mustone: Second the motion.

Roll: Jenny Graham/Sharon Hays/Kathy Kreatz/Melanie McLaughlin/Mea Mustone/Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Yes. No: Paul Ruseau. Motion approved 6/1.

Paul Ruseau: Motion to schedule this meeting now.

Jenny Graham: Second.

Jenny Graham: January 24th works for me. Mea Mustone: me too. Paul Ruseau; Me too.

4. Whereas students and families have been charged more than \$200 per class for summer remediation and credit recovery,

And whereas students enrolled in summer remediation and credit recovery are disproportionately more vulnerable subgroups, including economically disadvantaged students, students with disabilities and English learners,

Be it Resolved Medford Public Schools will no longer charge students identified as belonging in the subgroups, economically disadvantaged, English Learners and students with disabilities for remediation programming and credit recovery during summer programming and the academic year commencing June 1, 2022.

Be it further resolved that all students requiring credit remediation to prevent retention be notified in writing through the United States postage system and email 45 days before the last day of school.

- *Submitted by Melanie McLaughlin and Mea Mustone*

8:49 *Melanie:*

*Mea:*

Paul Ruseau: I don't have a problem with the concept of this but do we know how much money we are talking about?

Dave Murphy: I don't have the exact number but it would be easy to calculate. The point I want to raise is there is good intention behind the proposal. We do have a set of criteria that the central office provided to school administrators as to when fees should be waived. Very often administrators were waiving fees for services provided. If the committee passes this policy and would add these two subgroups to this other document. The summer program usually runs at a deficit of at least \$2000. If we waive, the deficit will increase. I do think there is a rationale to the fee for credit recovery because in some cases the fee serves as an incentive to students completing the program once they are enrolled in it. We don't want to diminish participation for students for whom this is a beneficial program. If it were tabled until Jan. 24, I could get more data.

Melanie McLaughlin: I would table it until Jan. 24. I appreciate the introspection. We want to rule out implicit bias towards the three groups who fall into this group (EL, Students with disabilities and socio-economically advantaged students). We need to think about the whole child in this approach.

Supt. Edouard-Vincent: I know it is being tabled until the next meeting. The last sentence: be it further resolved .....students would be emailed 45 days before the last day of school. Those last 45 days can impact the determination of whether students need to attend credit recovery. It really comes down to the last term for many students. We would probably need to look at that 45 day mark. I would like to look at that with Dr. Cushing and the secondary principals.

Melanie: I appreciate that input. Retention can be an incentive. I motion to table this until Jan. 24.

Jenny Graham: Second

Jenny Graham:yes, Sharon Hays: yes, Kathy Kreatz: yes, Melanie McLaughlin: yes, Mea Mustone: yes, Paul Ruseau; yes, Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes. Motion is tabled until next meeting.

5. Policy BEDH section II will have the sentence "Written comments must be kept to a length that allows for them to be read into the record in less than three (3) minutes or the comments will be summarized by the Secretary of the School Committee." replaced with the sentence "Written comments will be forwarded to all members of the School Committee by the Secretary of the School Committee in a timely fashion."

- *Offered by: Paul Ruseau, Jenny Graham*

Paul Ruseau: We have had a year when we started doing this during the pandemic when we read emails and then included them in the record. If the public wishes to speak, they can raise their hands and speak but I think reading the emails into the record isn't working and I don't see any other community doing it. The secretary will continue to monitor the email box and forward the emails to other members upon reading them.

Motion to approve: Jenny Graham

Melanie McLaughlin: through the chair, I think it was started when we switched to zoom. It was the chair not the secretary who was reading them.

Paul Ruseau: Yes, it was the Vice Chair who was reading it. I have switched it to the secretary.

Melanie McLaughlin: I know there are community members with anxiety who are afraid to speak at the meeting. I would like an amendment that allows people to state they would like to have it read into the record.

Paul: I don't have a problem with the concept of it but I have a problem with the implementation. I am uncomfortable when a person writes 9 questions for an administrator? Paulette at times did decline to read emails aloud due to the content because some people will type what they actually would not come and say it aloud in front of the chambers. I prefer the black and white that I don't read them in. Public records requests can be used to access them. The issue we need to address, when we did the policy updates to public comment, and we spoke about providing name and address and that sometimes should be protected information.

Melanie: That explanation is helpful. A person can reach out to one of us and ask to be put on the agenda. Sounds good - thank you.

Melanie: Second it.

Roll: Jenny Graham: yes, Sharon Hays: yes, Melanie McLaughlin: Yes, Mea Mustone: yes; Kathy Kreatz: yes; Paul Ruseau: yes; Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes

7/0 paper passes at 9:08

## **Condolences**

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Malverina “Chickie” Myles, great aunt of Kim Myles, the Data Director for the Medford Public Schools.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Lena J. Muccini, mother of former Mayor Stephanie Muccini Burke. Mrs. Muccini also served as a lunch mother at the former Osgood Elementary School.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Phyllis M. Antonino, former nurse at Medford High School and aunt to former Andrews Middle School Assistant Principal David DiMattia.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Robert A. Sestito, grandfather of former Missituk Elementary School teacher Kristin Rabbitt Cardone.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Frances “Chickie” Morton, mother of Brooks Elementary School Administrative Assistant Michelle Morton Hardy and sister of the late Anna Glencross, longtime Administrative Assistant at the Medford Vocational Technical High School.

XIII. Next Meeting

- **Monday, January 24, 2022: Regular School Committee Meeting** - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom:  
<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/99048068111>

XIV. Adjournment

BLK: Congratulations to City Councillor Nicole Morell and the birth of her child.

Motion to adjourn: Melanie/Seconded by Jenny Graham and Kathy Kreatz

7/0